Digital Literacy Project

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Introduction

In today's increasingly connected academic and professional landscape, foundational digital skills are critical for success. This Digital Literacy project is designed around my role as a Student Digital Ambassador, tasked with helping my peers safely and effectively navigate the digital world. The objective of this portfolio is to demonstrate practical competency across five key modules: visual communication, professional digital presence, collaborative platforms, professional email etiquette, and cybercrime awareness. By completing these five tasks, I have developed a comprehensive resource that not only guides first-year students in establishing their online identities but also equips them with the necessary tools to collaborate efficiently and protect themselves against online threats.

Task 1 Write-up

For the Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic, I utilized Canva because of its accessible templates and professional visual assets. My design focuses on educating first-year students by highlighting three key pillars: **What is Digital Literacy**, **Building a Professional Online Presence**, and **Safe Internet Practices**. I structured the infographic to flow logically, starting with foundational concepts and moving into actionable advice. The visual hierarchy uses clear icons and contrasting colors to draw attention to crucial tips, such as maintaining a clean LinkedIn profile or using two-factor authentication. While creating this resource, one aspect I found particularly interesting was the challenge of distilling complex digital behaviors into concise, easily digestible bullet points without losing their impact. It required me to carefully prioritize information, ensuring the final deliverable was both visually engaging and highly informative for my peers.

Task 2 Write-up

For my foundational digital portfolio, I selected GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle, as these are critical platforms for the modern tech landscape. GitHub serves as an

industry-standard version control system. Over the next four years, I will use it to host my coding assignments, showcase personal projects, and track my technical growth. LinkedIn acts as my primary professional networking hub. Throughout my Integrated MTech studies, I plan to leverage it to connect with classmates, follow industry developments, and eventually seek out summer internship opportunities. Finally, Kaggle is a specialized community focused on data and machine learning. As I advance in my degree, I intend to utilize Kaggle to explore datasets, study code from experienced engineers, and participate in introductory challenges. Establishing these three profiles now allows me to build a professional digital footprint that will mature alongside my academic capabilities, ensuring I am fully prepared for the job market by graduation.

Task 3 Write-up

For Module 3, I explored both coding practice and cloud collaboration environments. To sharpen my programming logic, I created a HackerRank profile and completed an introductory Python challenge. Utilizing HackerRank will be highly beneficial for my academic journey, as it provides a structured environment to incrementally build and test my problem-solving skills, which are fundamental for mastering data structures and algorithms moving forward. For the collaboration requirement, I built a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms, integrating both multiple-choice and short-answer questions to test peer knowledge. I also connected the form to a Google Sheet to automatically track and organize incoming responses. Mastering Google Workspace tools like Forms and Sheets is crucial for academic collaboration; it allows for seamless data collection, efficient team surveys, and streamlined project organization during group assignments. Together, these platforms equip me with both the technical practice and the administrative efficiency required to succeed in my engineering degree.

Task 4 Write-up

A common situation where poor digital communication causes significant problems is when a student uses an overly casual tone or "text-speak" in an email to a potential employer or professor. For example, sending an email without a clear subject line, omitting a professional greeting, or using abbreviations like "u" instead of "you" can instantly damage the sender's credibility. In a professional context, this lack of etiquette often leads to the email being ignored, potentially costing the student a valuable internship or networking opportunity. This could easily be avoided by taking an extra minute to proofread the message, applying standard email structures—such as a concise subject line, a formal salutation, clear body paragraphs, and a professional sign-off. Treating every academic and professional email as a formal document ensures clear communication and builds a strong, respectful digital reputation.

Task 5 Write-up

While researching UPI payment fraud for this case study, what surprised me most was how heavily scammers rely on social engineering and manufactured urgency rather than complex hacking techniques. They exploit a victim's desire for a quick deal or fear of losing out, completely bypassing technical security measures by simply asking the user to hand over the keys. It was alarming to realize how easily a momentary lapse in judgment—like automatically entering a PIN when prompted—can lead to instant financial loss. As a result of this module, one habit I will personally change is my approach to online transactions with unverified sellers. I will strictly enforce a rule to never scan a QR code or click a payment link sent by a stranger, and I will always double-check the transaction flow before entering my UPI PIN.

Conclusion

Completing this Digital Literacy portfolio has significantly strengthened my technical and professional communication skills. Building my GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle profiles established a strong foundation for my future career, while practicing on platforms like HackerRank and Google Forms improved my technical problem-solving and collaboration abilities. Furthermore, drafting professional emails and researching UPI cybercrimes reinforced the importance of clear communication and proactive digital security. Overall, this project has equipped me with the practical tools and awareness necessary to thrive academically and eventually transition smoothly into the professional tech industry.

References

GitHub: https://github.com

Canva: https://canva.com

LinkedIn: https://linkedin.com

Kaggle: https://kaggle.com

HackerRank: https://hackerrank.com

Google Forms: https://forms.google.com